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Compulsory activation

Q. My PC runs three operating systems—Windows XP, Windows 2000 and Windows 98. A few days ago, during reboot, I was asked to activate Windows XP. I tried to do so online, but it showed me the error message ‘Online Services temporarily unavailable’. I then formatted the old partition, and installed the OS on a different partition. After a few days, I got a pop-up box asking me to activate Windows, again. Strangely, after pressing the OK button, it never asked me to activate again. What could be wrong?

Tamilarasan



Manually activate Windows to get updates

A. It seems that you have already activated your copy of Windows XP. You can verify this to be sure. To do so manually, go to **Start > Run** and type ‘oobe/msoobe /a’. If Windows XP is activated, then you will get a window say that the product is already activated. If not, then you will be

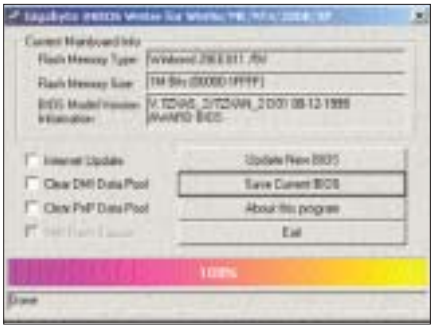
taken back to the Window where you activate Windows. If you get the later window, then you can carry on with the activation process and if you have any issues getting it done over the Internet, you can contact Microsoft India’s toll free number and get it activated over the phone.

Flashy BIOS

Q. I have a Pentium III 733 MHz processor on a Mercury KOB 815e FSX motherboard. I recently downloaded an update for my BIOS. As per the instructions, I created a DOS disk, copied the flash utility into it and ran it after restarting. It prompted me to provide the necessary ‘File Name to Program’. Since I did not know the name of the file, I just typed the model number of the motherboard, and the name of the updated file as the source file. It made me wait for more than a half an hour, after which I had to restart again. Before the memory test, it showed an error in the BIOS. Please help.

Rejin Ravi

A. Updating the BIOS is always a dangerous affair and the error you get is due to an improper update. It is advisable to take a backup of the BIOS. Also, before upgrading, make sure you have downloaded the right version for your motherboard. In your case, go to http://www.kobian.com/dl_mb_get.php for the latest version. Unzip the contents to a floppy, and configure the first boot device to Floppy in the BIOS. On restarting the machine, type the following:



Take a backup of the BIOS before updating it.

A:\AMIFLASH xxxxxx.bin or **A:\AWARDFLASH xxxxxx.bin**. Here, xxxxxx.bin is the name of the BIOS file. Press [Enter], and follow the instructions. After you are done, remove the floppy and restart the machine. This is the correct way to flash the BIOS. However, before you do this, please refer to the motherboard users manual and see if a corrupt BIOS flash can be recovered by setting any jumper on the motherboard. If it can be done, please recover the BIOS, reboot the computer and check if it is working fine. Then shut down the computer and perform the instructions mentioned above to flash the BIOS properly. If however, the corrupt BIOS cannot be recovered and your system remains unusable, then you will need to contact your system vendor to get this issue resolved.

A backup number

Q. Can you please tell me how to take a backup of my data in Tally using Nero?

Saura